

Backlog 06 12 Downstream Stewardship

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Backlog research 06-12 — AMR, Council contract, NTCRS, MobileMuster and batteries

Research date: 2 October 2026

Scope: items 6–12 of the Dubbo eWaste online-research backlog.

Status: current public-source research. Unknowns are preserved rather than guessed.

Confidence labels

- VERIFIED — directly supported by current primary/official sources.
- STRONG — supported by several credible sources but one link in the chain is not public.
- UNRESOLVED — public sources did not establish it; direct written confirmation remains necessary.

6. AMR Dubbo / Matthews / InfraBuild corporate history

6.1 What is verified now

The physical yard at 34 Mountbatten Drive, Dubbo is currently presented by Australian Metal Recycling as:

Dubbo — Formerly Matthews Metal Management
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AMR's current official contact page lists:

- 34 Mountbatten Drive, Dubbo NSW
- phone (02) 6882 1033
- Monday–Friday, 7:30 am–4:00 pm
- scrap-metal registration SM0759

Source:

<https://www.australianmetalrecycling.com.au/contact-us/>

6.2 Current legal operator

VERIFIED: the NSW Police Scrap Metal Industry Public Register dated 19 February 2026 lists:

- legal entity: Scrap Metal Services Pty Ltd
- ABN: 51 640 765 091
- registration: SM-0759

- business name: Australian Metal Recycling
- yard: 34 Mountbatten Drive, Dubbo
- yard manager: Gordon Matthews

ABN Lookup shows:

- Scrap Metal Services Pty Ltd active from 7 May 2020
- Australian Metal Recycling business name from 2 April 2025

6.3 Transition window from InfraBuild/OneSteel

Historic NSW Police registers provide a useful transition window.

February 2025

The Dubbo yard was listed under:

- OneSteel Recycling Pty Ltd
- InfraBuild / Matthews Metal Management
- registration SM-0103
- 34 Mountbatten Drive

17 July 2025

The public register still showed OneSteel/InfraBuild associated with the Dubbo Matthews yard.

19 February 2026

The yard is listed under Scrap Metal Services Pty Ltd / Australian Metal Recycling.

Conclusion: operational control changed after 17 July 2025 and before 19 February 2026.

Scrap Metal Services itself had already:

- registered as a scrap dealer on 24 June 2025
- registered the Australian Metal Recycling business name from April 2025.

6.4 Who are the Matthews behind AMR?

AMR states publicly that it was founded by John and Gordon Matthews, described as the original owners of Matthews Metal Management, and says it operates multiple regional yards including Dubbo.

This is evidence of management/founder continuity, but it is not enough to state the legal transaction structure.

6.5 What is not publicly established

UNRESOLVED:

- exact completion/settlement date of the yard transfer
- whether Scrap Metal Services bought land, plant, assets, customer book, lease rights or only operations
- whether OneSteel/InfraBuild still owns the land or has any commercial interest
- whether a novation/assignment of Council contracts occurred
- why InfraBuild still has an online Matthews Dubbo branch page

- the exact contractual relationship, if any, between the entities after transition.

Do not describe AMR as an InfraBuild subsidiary or InfraBuild brand. The public records point to separate legal entities.

6.6 EPA licence search

No indexed public EPA licence result was found for AMR/Scrap Metal Services at the Dubbo address during this research.

That does not prove there is no EPL. Search the EPA public register directly by:

- legal entity
- address
- licence number if supplied by AMR.

For the Phase 0 business, this does not change the rule: before sending waste there, confirm the Dubbo yard is legally authorised to receive the exact stream.

7. Current Dubbo Regional Council e-waste contract

7.1 Last publicly documented contract

VERIFIED: Dubbo Regional Council's adopted 2025–2035 Waste Strategy records:

- contractor: Matthews Metals
- description: Collection of E-Waste
- commencement: 30 June 2023
- expiry: 30 June 2025

Source:

https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/ArticleDocuments/242/Waste_Strategy_2025_Adopted.pdf.aspx

7.2 Evidence after the listed expiry

A June 2025 Wellington Waste Transfer Station pollution-response document still listed:

- Matthews Metal
- Scrap metal & E-Waste Recycling
- the Dubbo Matthews phone number

That demonstrates the relationship was operationally relevant at that point, but it does not prove a new contract after 30 June 2025.

7.3 GIPA contract register

Council publishes contracts worth, or likely worth, \$150,000+ GST inclusive in its GIPA Contract Register.

The current register searched did not expose a post-June-2025 e-waste contract.

That can mean several things:

- the successor arrangement is below the GIPA register threshold
- an annual RFQ/purchase arrangement is used
- a regional NetWaste arrangement applies
- an existing contract was assigned/varied
- a new award exists but is not indexed in the searched material.

It does not prove there is no current contractor.

Current Council access-to-information page:

<https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/about-council/meetings-and-documents/access-to-information>

7.4 Public procurement searches

Searches of:

- Council tender pages
- Council news/minutes
- current GIPA contract register
- indexed VendorPanel results

did not identify a public successor tender/award specifically titled Dubbo e-waste collection.

7.5 Current public service still exists

Council continues in 2026 to advertise e-waste acceptance at:

- Whylandra
- Wellington
- village/rural depots in domestic quantities where applicable.

Therefore material is still being collected; the missing piece is who currently removes/processes it under contract.

7.6 Best next information request

This gap is now narrow enough for an informal GIPA request:

Please provide the current contractor/supplier arrangement for collection and/or processing of electronic waste from Whylandra Waste and Recycling Centre, Wellington Waste Transfer Station and other Dubbo Regional Council facilities after 30 June 2025, including contractor name, commencement/expiry dates, relevant RFQ/tender reference, accepted streams, and whether the arrangement permits or requires reuse/refurbishment before material recycling.

Also ask:

- whether the former Matthews arrangement was assigned/novated to Scrap Metal Services Pty Ltd / Australian Metal Recycling
- whether any exclusivity prevents reusable electronics being diverted before recycling.

7.7 Exclusivity / reuse

UNRESOLVED: no public contract text found establishing:

- contractor exclusivity
- ownership transfer point
- whether Council may divert reusable equipment before collection
- whether the contractor may select devices for reuse
- whether destruction/recycling is contractually mandatory.

This is directly relevant to a future Council relationship.

8. What AMR Dubbo actually accepts

8.1 Confirmed public categories

AMR currently advertises free e-waste/electrical-waste recycling.

Its current material pages list or depict acceptance of:

- televisions
- computers/laptops
- monitors
- smartphones/tablets
- printers/scanners
- electrical waste generally.

It also advertises free onsite drop-off for:

- scrap steel
- electrical waste.

Sources:

- <https://www.australianmetalrecycling.com.au/>
- <https://www.australianmetalrecycling.com.au/what-we-recycle/>
- <https://www.australianmetalrecycling.com.au/contact-us/>

8.2 Lithium exclusion

VERIFIED: AMR's current materials wording excludes lithium-ion e-waste/batteries in its accepted-material framework and separately lists lithium batteries as not accepted.

This creates an ambiguity for modern laptops, phones and tablets that contain embedded lithium batteries.

8.3 Specific categories still unresolved

Public pages do not clearly establish the Dubbo-yard rule for:

- CRT televisions
- CRT monitors
- cracked LCD/LED TVs
- smashed/incomplete devices
- laptops with removable lithium batteries still installed
- laptops with internal batteries
- phones/tablets with embedded batteries
- loose printed circuit boards
- RAM, CPUs and cards
- power supplies/chargers
- mixed cables
- toner/ink
- mixed unsorted commercial loads.

Do not infer these from the generic “e-waste” wording.

8.4 Commercial quantities and pricing

AMR advertises free e-waste recycling generally, but public material does not establish:

- business-volume caps
- minimum quantities
- whether all commercial e-waste is free
- whether some fractions attract a charge
- whether some commodity fractions attract payment.

8.5 Pickup / cage / paperwork

UNRESOLVED publicly:

- minimum pickup load
- cage/bin supply
- pallet rules
- weight tickets for e-waste
- recycling receipts
- certificates of recycling
- serialised asset reporting.

8.6 Phase 0 conclusion

AMR remains a promising local residual outlet, but Dubbo eWaste should not accept a low-value category solely because AMR says “e-waste” online.

Before accepting that category, get a yes/no answer from AMR for the exact item, especially if it has lithium batteries.

9. AMR's downstream chain

9.1 What is publicly known

AMR publicly describes services including:

- collection
- metal/electrical waste recycling
- consolidation
- transport
- public recycling events
- business solutions.

Its public Dubbo material does not name the specialist electronics facility that receives the e-waste after intake.

9.2 No named first downstream recipient found

Despite searches across:

- AMR
- Matthews
- InfraBuild
- NTCRS
- TechCollect
- NSW regional waste material

no current source was found that says:

AMR Dubbo sends its e-waste to [named facility].

That remains a genuine evidence gap.

See the repo's separate forensic file:

AMR-DUBBO-DOWNSTREAM-FORENSIC.md (AMR-DUBBO-DOWNSTREAM-FORENSIC.md)

9.3 Dismantling in Dubbo

UNRESOLVED: no public evidence found of a specialist electronics dismantling/shredding line at the Mountbatten Drive yard.

The public business description is more consistent with:

- collection
- weighing/sorting
- consolidation
- transport

than a complete electronics-material processing plant.

Do not state that no dismantling occurs; simply state it has not been demonstrated publicly.

9.4 NTCRS / AS 5377 status

No current public evidence found that:

- AMR Dubbo is itself an approved NTCRS co-regulatory arrangement
- the Dubbo yard is a listed TechCollect collection partner
- the yard itself is an AS 5377-certified recycler.

TechCollect's current NSW collection-partner list does not include Dubbo/AMR/Matthews.

This does not exclude AMR acting as:

- a subcontractor
- aggregator
- transporter
- non-public partner.

9.5 Current regional candidate processors

Current TechCollect/NTCRS research identifies certified specialist recyclers elsewhere, and the broader repo has identified Sircel as a strong Central West research lead.

However:

There is still no evidence AMR Dubbo sends its material to Sircel.

Keep candidate and verified chains separate.

9.6 Data destruction

No public AMR Dubbo material found guarantees:

- NIST/ASD sanitisation
- drive shredding
- serial-level destruction
- certificates of data destruction.

Until AMR supplies this in writing, Dubbo eWaste should sanitise/remove data-bearing media before material leaves its custody.

9.7 Exact questions for AMR

Ask:

1. Where does Dubbo e-waste physically go next?
2. What legal entity receives it?
3. At what facility/address is first-stage electronics processing done?
4. Does any electronics dismantling occur in Dubbo?

5. Is that downstream facility AS 5377 certified?
6. Is the material counted under an NTCRS co-regulatory arrangement?
7. Which co-regulator?
8. What happens to PCBs, plastics, steel, aluminium/copper, glass and batteries?
9. Are any fractions exported? Under what permit/path?
10. Can AMR provide a recycling certificate/weight ticket?
11. Is serialised HDD/SSD destruction available?
12. What is the rule for embedded lithium batteries?

10. NTCRS opportunities

10.1 Current approved co-regulators

VERIFIED, DCCEEW updated 20 May 2026:

Approved National Television and Computer Recycling Scheme co-regulatory arrangements are:

1. Activ Group Solutions Pty Ltd — Ecoactiv
2. Australia and New Zealand Recycling Platform Ltd — TechCollect
3. Ecocycle Pty Ltd
4. Ecycle Solutions Pty Ltd
5. Sustainable Product Stewards Pty Ltd

Source:

<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/product-stewardship/products-schemes/television-computer-recycling-scheme/coreg-arrangements>

10.2 Who gets free services

VERIFIED: households and small businesses have access to free NTCRS collection services for covered products at designated collection points/services.

Source:

<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/product-stewardship/television-computer-recycling-scheme>

The government page does not set a simple universal “X devices per small business” quantity cap; service-specific acceptance can vary.

10.3 Covered products

VERIFIED covered categories include:

Televisions

- colour TVs
- black-and-white TVs

Computers

- laptops
- notebooks
- palmtops
- tablets
- personal computers
- PC CPUs
- monitors/projectors
- CRT and flat-screen monitors

Printers

- multi-function
- single-function

Computer parts/peripherals

- keyboards
- joysticks/game pads
- mice/trackballs
- scanners
- CD/DVD drives
- hard drives
- memory/network/sound/video/IDE/SCSI and similar cards.

Source:

<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/consumers/recycling-drop-off>

This is broader than the Phase 0 acceptance list and creates a potential free residual route for eligible products.

10.4 CRTs

VERIFIED: CRT monitors are expressly within the Commonwealth covered-product list. Televisions are also covered.

This does not mean every local collection point will accept a CRT without conditions; check the actual service.

10.5 AS 5377

VERIFIED: NTCRS co-regulatory arrangements are expected to contract recycling only to facilities currently certified to AS 5377.

The government's material-recovery target is 90% by weight sent for further processing into usable materials.

10.6 Becoming a collection partner

TechCollect publicly invites:

- local councils
- waste management organisations
- selected retail/business partners.

It says partnership can be free and include:

- signage/marketing
- staff training
- collection units
- transport
- recycling.

Source:

<https://techcollect.com.au/our-partners/partner-with-us/>

Dubbo eWaste opportunity

This is worth approaching after the planning status of the shed operation is resolved.

Possible model:

- Dubbo eWaste removes viable reuse devices first where permitted
- eligible residual NTCRS products go into a co-reg-funded collection stream
- no direct downstream disposal fee.

But confirm that the co-regulator permits reuse triage and how ownership/data responsibilities work.

10.7 TechCollect current NSW list

TechCollect's current public NSW collection-partner list includes multiple Council/waste sites but does not list Dubbo, Matthews or AMR.

That weakens any claim that the AMR yard is currently a public TechCollect collection partner.

Source:

<https://techcollect.com.au/our-partners/>

10.8 Certification distinction

Do not conflate:

- collection site/partner

with

- contracted recycler.

AS 5377 certification obligations in Commonwealth guidance apply to the recycling facilities/service providers used for NTCRS recycling. A small local collection partner may participate through a co-regulator's logistics/recycler network rather than becoming an industrial recycler itself.

11. MobileMuster

11.1 What it is

VERIFIED: MobileMuster is the official Australian mobile-industry product stewardship scheme for mobile phones.

11.2 Free pickup

Registered sites can book a free pickup. Non-registered organisations can also contact MobileMuster for a one-off pickup, or join for ongoing collections.

Source:

<https://www.mobilemuster.com.au/book-a-pickup/>

11.3 Standard accepted items

The standard program accepts:

- mobile phones
- chargers
- mobile accessories.

Selected carrier stores may also take some specific smart devices.

11.4 What is not accepted in the ordinary program

MobileMuster explicitly says it does not accept:

- loose mobile-phone batteries
- iPads/tablets
- other electronics.

This means Dubbo eWaste needs a separate tablet/downstream route.

11.5 Partner model

MobileMuster says it works with:

- retailers
- service providers
- repair stores
- councils
- charities
- workplaces.

It can supply collection units and offers free pickup/reporting support.

This makes it a realistic future Phase 0/1 partner for dead phones once the premises model is approved.

11.6 Public versus organisation-only site

MobileMuster's join process can support:

- a public drop-off point
- organisation-only collection.

For a residential startup, organisation-only/non-public collection is the safer concept until Council/insurance approve public visitation.

11.7 Data

MobileMuster says data is destroyed as part of recycling. For Dubbo eWaste, retain the stronger internal rule:

- data wipe before downstream handoff where practicable
- do not rely on generic scheme marketing for client-level destruction certification.

12. B-cycle / damaged lithium batteries

12.1 B-cycle is not a simple “buy a bin” solution

VERIFIED: to become a B-cycle drop-off point the organisation must:

1. find an accredited B-cycle Collector
2. choose an appropriate container with the Collector
3. complete a Site Risk Assessment and Safety Plan
4. meet the scheme commitments/code
5. have authority to register the site.

B-cycle does not simply provide a free public battery bin.

Sources:

- <https://bcycle.com.au/register/>
- <https://bcycle.com.au/register/form/>

12.2 Who pays/gets rebates

B-cycle says drop-off points are not eligible for collection rebates. Rebates are aimed at accredited Collectors transporting batteries in bulk.

A drop-off point works commercially with its accredited Collector.

12.3 Badly damaged or swollen batteries

VERIFIED: badly damaged, swollen or bulging batteries must not be put into an ordinary B-cycle drop-off point.

B-cycle says:

- use a fire-resistant, non-airtight container

- contact Council/transfer station
- if they cannot assist, contact an accredited B-cycle Collector for advice.

Source:

<https://bcycle.com.au/>

12.4 Ordinary battery transport/preparation

For ordinary undamaged loose batteries, B-cycle advises:

- tape terminals
- prevent terminals touching
- transport in a suitable container.

12.5 Nearest Dubbo accredited commercial collector

UNRESOLVED from indexed web search.

The B-cycle network uses an interactive location/collector finder rather than exposing a simple indexed Dubbo list in search results.

Use B-cycle's "Find a Collector" service and ask specifically for:

- commercial pickup in Dubbo
- damaged/swollen lithium batteries
- minimum pickup
- packaging/UN-approved container rules
- dangerous-goods transport
- charges.

12.6 Phase 0 recommendation

Do not add public battery collection.

Accepting ordinary phones/laptops with healthy embedded batteries is a different question from advertising a loose-battery service.

At startup:

- reject visibly swollen/damaged/wet/fire-affected battery devices
- no loose battery intake
- have one identified specialist route for a battery discovered damaged after intake.

Priority conclusions from items 6-12

1. AMR is now clearly the current operator of the former Matthews Dubbo yard, but the precise transaction with InfraBuild is not publicly documented.
2. Council's last published Matthews e-waste contract expired 30 June 2025; no public successor award has yet been identified.

3. AMR publicly accepts broad e-waste for free, but lithium wording is the critical ambiguity for modern devices.
4. AMR's exact downstream processor remains unverified; do not invent a Sircel/TechCollect chain.
5. The NTCRS is the strongest potential zero-cost residual stream for TVs/computers/printers/peripherals.
6. TechCollect explicitly offers free collection-partner infrastructure to selected partners, making it worth a direct approach.
7. MobileMuster is a strong free pathway for phones/chargers/accessories, but not tablets or loose batteries.
8. B-cycle adds risk/administration that Phase 0 does not need. No public battery collection at launch.

Best next calls/emails from items 6-12

AMR Dubbo

Ask for:

- exact accepted items with/without embedded lithium
- business pricing/limits
- first downstream processor
- AS 5377/NTCRS relationship
- data-destruction options
- recycling certificates/weights
- pickup/cage terms.

Dubbo Regional Council / GIPA

Ask for:

- successor e-waste contract after 30 June 2025
- assignment/novation to AMR
- reuse rights
- exclusivity and ownership point.

TechCollect / other NTCRS co-regulators

Ask:

- will a Dubbo reuse/refurb business qualify as a collection partner?
- minimum volume
- free cage/pickup
- reuse-before-recycle rules
- reporting/certificates.

MobileMuster

Ask for an organisation-only account/pickup arrangement.

B-cycle

Only investigate a commercial Collector for emergency/failed-battery disposal, not a public drop point.

Primary sources

- Australian Metal Recycling

<https://www.australianmetalrecycling.com.au/>

- NSW Police Scrap Metal Industry

https://www.police.nsw.gov.au/online_services/scrap_metal_industry

- ABN Lookup

<https://abr.business.gov.au/>

- Dubbo Regional Council Waste Strategy 2025-2035

https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/ArticleDocuments/242/Waste_Strategy_2025_Adopted.pdf.aspx

- Dubbo Regional Council Access to Information / GIPA contracts

<https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/about-council/meetings-and-documents/access-to-information>

- DCCEEW NTCRS

<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/product-stewardship/television-computer-recycling-scheme>

- DCCEEW co-regulatory arrangements

<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/product-stewardship/products-schemes/television-computer-recycling-scheme/coreg-arrangements>

- DCCEEW covered products

<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/consumers/recycling-drop-off>

- TechCollect partner page

<https://techcollect.com.au/our-partners/partner-with-us/>

- TechCollect current collection partners

<https://techcollect.com.au/our-partners/>

- MobileMuster

<https://www.mobilemuster.com.au/book-a-pickup/>

- B-cycle

<https://bcycle.com.au/>

- B-cycle registration

<https://bcycle.com.au/register/>